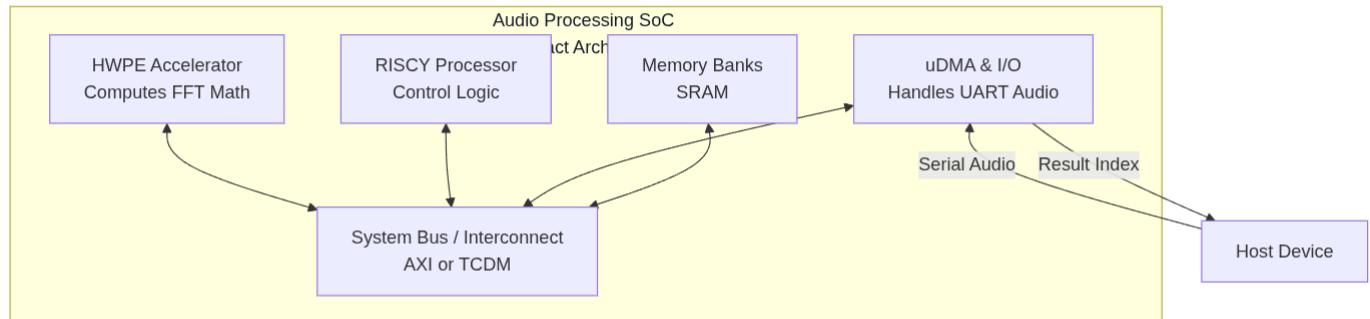


Audio Processing SoC Design Assignment

1. SoC Architecture Block Diagram



Component Descriptions:

- **Processor Core (CPU):** Manages the overall system operation, configures peripherals, triggers the FFT accelerator, and executes the peak detection algorithm (software).
- **Memory (SRAM):** Acts as the central storage for incoming audio samples, intermediate FFT results, and the main program instructions.
- **Serial Interface (UART/SPI):** The communication bridge with the host device to receive raw audio samples and transmit the final dominant frequency location.
- **DMA Controller:** Handles bulk data movement (e.g., from UART to Memory, and Memory to FFT Accelerator) without interrupting the CPU, maximizing system efficiency.
- **FFT Hardware Accelerator:** A dedicated digital logic block designed to compute the Fast Fourier Transform highly efficiently, offloading this computationally heavy task from the CPU.

2. Hardware-Software Partitioning

Hardware Modules

Serial Communication (UART/SPI): Implemented in hardware because serial protocols require precise timing and continuous bit-level sampling that would waste CPU cycles if done via bit-banging.

DMA Controller: Implemented in hardware to enable parallel operation. The CPU can sleep or do other work while the DMA autonomously moves incoming audio samples into memory.

FFT Accelerator: The Fast Fourier Transform is computationally expensive ($O(N \log N)$). Implementing it as a custom hardware accelerator significantly reduces processing time, lowers power consumption, and ensures real-time constraints are met for continuous audio streams.

Software Modules

System Control & Orchestration: The CPU runs software to initialize the DMA, configure the UART, and

start the FFT accelerator. Managing the control flow is inherently sequential and well-suited for a general-purpose processor.

Peak Detection (Finding Dominant Frequency): Identifying the highest frequency component requires iterating over the FFT results and finding the maximum value. This is a simple linear search ($O(N)$). Since it's not computationally intensive, implementing it in software is highly efficient and saves silicon area that would be wasted on a dedicated peak-detector hardware block.

3. Algorithm Pseudocode (Software Part)

```
1  function main():
2      // 1. Initialization Phase
3      Initialize_UART(baud_rate=115200)
4      Initialize_DMA()
5      Initialize_FFT_Accelerator(fft_size=1024)
6
7      allocate audio_buffer[1024]
8      allocate fft_output[1024]
9
10     // Main Processing Loop
11     while True:
12         // 2. Receive Audio Samples
13         // CPU configures DMA to move data from UART RX to memory and goes to sleep/waits
14         Start_DMA_Transfer(source=UART_RX, destination=audio_buffer, size=1024)
15         Wait_For_Interrupt(DMA_COMPLETE)
16
17         // 3. Hardware Acceleration (FFT)
18         // CPU configures the accelerator registers with buffer addresses and triggers execution
19         Write_Register(FFT_INPUT_ADDR, address_of(audio_buffer))
20         Write_Register(FFT_OUTPUT_ADDR, address_of(fft_output))
21         Write_Register(FFT_CONTROL, START_EXECUTION)
22
23         Wait_For_Interrupt(FFT_COMPLETE)
24
25         // 4. Software Processing: Peak Detection
26         dominant_freq_index = 0
27         max_magnitude = 0
28
29         // Iterate through the first half of the FFT output (Nyquist limit)
30         for i from 0 to 512:
31             // Calculate magnitude: sqrt(real^2 + imag^2)
32             // (Note: in practice, we can just compare squared magnitudes to save computation)
33             magnitude_squared = (fft_output[i].real * fft_output[i].real) +
34                                 (fft_output[i].imag * fft_output[i].imag)
35
36             if magnitude_squared > max_magnitude:
37                 max_magnitude = magnitude_squared
38                 dominant_freq_index = i
39
40         // 5. Transmit Results
```

```
41 // Send the location of the dominant frequency back to the host
42 Send_UART_Data(dominant_freq_index)
```